

Product Writeup Guideline

0. The Basics

- **Product Name:**
Contextual Risk Review System
- **Product One-liner (< 150 words)**
A contextual risk assessment assistant that helps SecOps teams evaluate vulnerability risk acceptance requests consistently using deployment context, mitigating controls, and structured scoring
- **Team Members & Respective Divisions**
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- **Cover Image:**



1. Problem Statement

- **Users:**
Service product and security support team
- **Use Case:**
Assessment officers review announced vulnerabilities and determined their contextualised risk, including residual risk if patches are not applied on time. This process is currently carried out manually through Service Now and requires multiple levels of endorsement before patching decisions can be made.

- **Pain Point:**
To assess each vulnerability accurately, officers need to understand the affected system's architecture and exposure, as well as the possible methods by which the vulnerability could be exploited. Gathering and synthesising this context manually is laborious and time-consuming.
- **Consequence:** Without an automated solution, contextualised risk assessments will remain slow and resource-intensive, leading to delays in critical patching decisions. This leaves systems exposed to exploitable vulnerabilities for longer than necessary, increasing the organisation's security risk. The manual process also creates a bottleneck that slows response times to emerging threats.

2. User Research and Market Analysis

- **User Research:**
Conduct interviews with assessment officers asking about their current workflow, pain points, and time spent per assessment
- **De-risking:**
Accuracy and adoption
- **Stakeholder Buy-in:** Service product and security support teams

3. Solutioning

- **Problem-Solution Fit:**
The product automatically ingests vulnerability announcements and cross-references them against known system architecture and exposure data, generating a contextualised risk assessment for the officer to review and send for endorsement
- **Functionality:**
When a vulnerability is announced → the system ingests it → it analyses affected systems and exposure → it generates a risk assessment with recommended action → the officer reviews and endorses → the decision is logged.
- **User Experience:**
Reduce the steps and increase the accuracy of the product provided
- **User Validation:** Haven't conduct any user testing with prototype at this point

4. Impact & Next Steps

- **Success Metrics:**

Based on the number of vulnerability assessments completed through the platform, a high number indicates officers find it useful and have adopted it into their workflow

- **Expected Impact:** To pilot with a small group of assessment officers (example: 5-10), targeting a 50% reduction in time spent per vulnerability assessment